



Growfit Sports Academy NPC

Grassroots football · U12 · U15 · U17 · Greater Durban, KwaZulu-Natal

EVENT PROPOSAL · HIGH STAKES EDITION · OCTOBER 2026

Growfit Youth Cup High Stakes Edition

A one-day, high-stakes tournament for the strongest U12, U15 and U17 teams in Greater Durban. **Half of every entry fee goes into the prize pool**, so winners take home up to R8,000 per division. The event pays for itself from entries and the gate. Sponsorship makes it bigger, but it doesn't depend on it.

24 teams

8 per age group · about 360 young players

54 matches

On one day, across three pitches

R48,000

Prize pool at 24 teams, paid from 50% of entry fees

Contact

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Event

Date: [\[Saturday, school holidays\]](#)
Venue: [\[venue, Greater Durban\]](#)
Sanctioned through: [\[GDLFA / SAFA eThekwin\]](#)

1 The idea

During the school holidays, grassroots players in Durban have few chances to play competitive football. The Growfit Youth Cup fills that gap. It is a one-day tournament for **U12, U15 and U17** teams, run to the same standards Growfit applies every week: qualified referees, first aid on site, safeguarding, and every child getting meaningful game time.

3

Age groups: U12, U15, U17

8

Teams per age group

4–5

Matches guaranteed per team

R4,000

Entry fee per team (about R285 per player)

Format

ELEMENT	DETAIL
Group stage	Two groups of four per age group. Every team plays three group matches.
Knockouts	Group winners and runners-up play semi-finals, the final and a 3rd-place play-off. Teams finishing 3rd and 4th play placement matches for 5th–8th, so nobody goes home after three games.
Match length	U12: 2 × 10 min (9-a-side). U15 and U17: 2 × 10 min (11-a-side). One pitch per division, three full-size pitches in total. Final lengths are confirmed with the sanctioning body.
Squads	Up to 14 players per team, with rolling substitutions. SAFA/LFA-registered players only, with a team list and age verification at check-in.
Awards	Trophies and medals, plus real prizes : equipment vouchers, a new match kit for each winning team, boots and gloves for individual winners, and a camp bursary for the most promising player in each division (Section 4). Every player gets a participation certificate.
Extras	A coaches' breakfast and short coaching talk. Match filming if the academy camera is in place. A family zone with food vendors.

Why Growfit can deliver it

Growfit is a registered NPC running three age groups in the Greater Durban Football League. It has eight adopted policies, including Child Protection & Safeguarding and Injury & Medical Emergency. Every player is registered with SAFA and every coach is CPR Part B checked. Our weekly matchday routine (registration checks, attendance, first aid, communication with parents) is the same routine a tournament needs, only bigger.

2 What participating clubs get

Quality football

At least four competitive matches per team in one day, against opponents of similar age from across Durban. That is more game time than a month of league weekends.

High stakes, real money

R4,000 per team (about R285 per player). **Half of every entry fee goes straight into the prize pool:** up to R8,000 for each division's winners, paid to the club. Early-bird entry is R3,500 for the first 12 paid entries before **[date]**, payable in two instalments.

Safe and well run

Qualified referees, a first-aid station, a named safety officer, a safeguarding lead and a lost-child point. Parents know what to expect.

Visibility for players

Individual awards, certificates and match footage (where available) help players with trials and school sports programmes. Scouts and school coaches are invited.

Coach development

A coaches' breakfast with a short talk (e.g. "Game-time for every player") and a chance to connect with other grassroots coaches.

Recognition

Each club is named in the programme, on social media and in the results sheet sent to all participants.

3 What sponsors get

The Cup **pays for itself** from entry fees, the gate and vendors (Section 6). Sponsorship makes it bigger. Every R10,000 of sponsorship can add R10,000 to the prize pool (headline: "R58,000 in prizes"), **or** pay for 2 bursary entries for strong clubs from poor communities, **or** upgrade the event: live-stream, photographer, stadium venue.

PACKAGE	INCLUDES	VALUE
Headline Partner (1)	Event named "Growfit Youth Cup presented by [Partner] ". Logo on banners, medals ribbon, certificates and all posts. Presents the trophies. Branded stall in the family zone. B-BBEE socio-economic development letter.	R15,000
Pitch Partner (3)	A pitch named after the partner (" [Partner] Pitch"), with pitch-side banner and mentions on the PA and social media.	R3,000 each
Medals & Awards Partner (1)	Logo on medal ribbons and certificates. Presents the individual awards.	R5,000
Refreshment Partner (in kind)	Provides water, fruit or snacks for players. Sampling stand and logo on the programme.	In kind
Community Supporter	Any amount or service: printing, transport, gazebos, PA system, first-aid supplies. Thanked in the programme and on social media.	Any

Growfit does not accept sponsorship from alcohol or tobacco/vaping brands. Licensed betting partners are welcome. On children's kit, medals and certificates their branding is limited to name and logo, with no betting promotions aimed at under-18s.

4 Prizes worth playing for

The prize pool is **50% of all entry fees**, so it grows with every team that enters and can never put the event at risk. At 24 teams it's **R48,000: R16,000 per division**. The pool is announced as "up to R48,000", and the final figure is confirmed when entries close.

AWARD (EACH DIVISION: U12 · U15 · U17)	PRIZE	AT 24 TEAMS	AT 14 TEAMS
Winners	Trophy, gold medals and R8,000 for the club	R8,000	R4,650
Runners-up	Silver medals and R4,000 for the club	R4,000	R2,350
3rd place	Bronze medals and R2,000 for the club	R2,000	R1,150
Player of the Tournament	Trophy and R1,000 boots voucher	R1,000	R600
Golden Glove	Trophy and R500 goalkeeper-gloves voucher	R500	R290
Fair Play award	R500 equipment voucher for the club	R500	R290
Per division		R16,000	R9,330

Fair play with real money at stake

- ✓ **Prize money goes to the club, never to children.** It's paid by EFT to the club's bank account within 7 days of the event. On the day, winners receive a giant cheque.
- ✓ **Strict eligibility:** SAFA/LFA registration cards and ID or birth certificates are checked at check-in. Age disputes go to the tournament committee before the knockouts, and a team that fields an ineligible player forfeits its prize.
- ✓ **Qualified referees** for every match, with assistant referees for semi-finals and finals. The tournament committee's decision on disputes is final.
- ✓ Individual awards are equipment vouchers, not cash.

Sponsors can add to the pool

Division Prize Partner	Adds R5,000 or more to one division's prizes. The division is named " [Partner] U15 Cup", and you present the prizes on stage.
Award Partner	Adds a named award across all divisions, e.g. "Golden Boot by [Partner] " (R1,200–R2,500, or product).
Kit Prize Partner	A new match kit for each division winner, with your logo on it.

5 How partners are showcased on the day

We showcase partners the way established tournaments do, and we make sure every partner's investment is seen, photographed and reported.

- ✓ **Posters & social graphics:** a sponsor logo strip on every poster, fixture list, results graphic and story
- ✓ **Photo wall:** every team, winner and VIP photo is taken in front of a backdrop with your logo
- ✓ **Pitch-side:** banners, flags and named pitches (" **[Partner]** Pitch")
- ✓ **Stage & PA:** hourly mentions by the MC, and partners present the prizes
- ✓ **Sponsor village:** a stall or gazebo in the family zone for sampling, offers and sign-ups
- ✓ **VIP tent:** partners and their guests are hosted for the finals and prize-giving
- ✓ **Live coverage & take-home items:** posts, stories and a highlight reel with partner end-cards, plus medal ribbons, certificates and the programme kept by ~360 families. Media invited
- ✓ **Post-event report:** attendance, reach, photos of your branding and the finances, within 30 days

6 Budget: balanced without sponsors

Planning estimates, to be updated with real quotes. Costs include the prize pool, and **no sponsorship is counted**. The event balances on entry fees, the gate and vendors alone. Shown at full capacity (24 teams) and at the minimum to go ahead (14 teams).

Costs

ITEM	24 TEAMS	14 TEAMS
Referees (R450 per team)	10,800	6,300
Assistant referees for semis & finals	2,000	2,000
Venue hire (3 pitches, full day)	6,000	6,000
First-aid / paramedic standby	4,000	4,000
Trophies & medals	4,000	4,000
Security, marshals & cash handling	5,000	5,000
Gazebos, stage & PA	3,500	3,500
Drinking water for players	2,000	2,000
Event liability insurance	2,000	2,000
Banners, programme & printing	1,500	1,500
Admin, safety plan & permits	1,000	1,000
Participation certificates	500	500
Contingency (10%)	4,200	3,800
Prize pool (50% of entries)	48,000	28,000
Total costs	R94,500	R69,600

Income

SOURCE	24 TEAMS	14 TEAMS
Entry fees (R4,000 per team)	96,000	56,000
Gate: ~450 adults × R30 (under-12s free)	13,500	13,500
Food vendor stalls (10 × R800)	8,000	8,000
Total income	R117,500	R77,500

Surplus: R23,000 at 24 teams · R7,900 at 14 teams. It goes to the academy's player-support fund and pays Growfit's own tournament entries. Any sponsorship comes on top.

If the gate brings in only half the estimate, the surplus is still about R16,250 at 24 teams and R1,150 at 14 teams. The early-bird discount (R500 per team) is limited to the first 12 paid entries, so it costs at most R6,000.

Go / no-go (6 weeks before)

- At least 14 teams entered and paid
- Venue, referees and first aid booked in writing
- Sanction from the LFA/region received

If these aren't met, the event is postponed and all entry fees are refunded in full.

7 Safety, safeguarding & compliance

AREA	HOW IT IS HANDLED
Sanctioning	The tournament is registered with the Greater Durban LFA / SAFA eThekweni Region, and their rules and referee appointments are followed.
Event safety (SASREA)	The event's risk category is confirmed with the municipality and SAPS under the Safety at Sports and Recreational Events Act. In all cases: a named safety officer, a written safety plan (crowd, parking, emergency medical, evacuation) and a briefing for all marshals.
Medical	Paramedic or qualified first-aid standby all day. Each team submits medical and emergency details. Concussion protocol: "if in doubt, sit them out". The nearest hospital route is in the safety plan.
Safeguarding	A named safeguarding lead. Team officials are accredited and wear tags, and only accredited adults are allowed in player areas. Lost-child point, no changing-room access for spectators, and a clear process for reporting concerns.
Photos & filming (POPIA)	Entry form confirms each club holds media consent for its players. Filming signage at the venue. Players without consent are not featured. Footage is shared only with the player's own club.
Weather & heat	Shaded areas, water points and drinks breaks in hot weather. A lightning and severe-weather stop rule. A rain-date plan is agreed with the venue.
Discipline & fair play	Code of conduct for players, officials and parents. A tournament committee rules on disputes. Zero tolerance for abuse of referees.
Money	Entry fees by EFT only, with reference = team name. Vendors pay in advance. Gate takings by SnapScan or card where possible, and any cash is counted by two people and banked within 2 working days. Income and spending are reported to sponsors within 30 days.

8 Event team

ROLE	WHO	MAIN TASKS
Tournament Director	Buhle Madlala	Overall lead, sponsors, sanctioning, referees
Competitions & Registration	Khaya Madlala	Entries, team lists, age checks, fixtures and results
Operations & Equipment	Sphe Mlotshwa	Venue layout, equipment, marshals, vendors
Safety Officer	[name]	Safety plan, first-aid liaison, emergency response
Safeguarding Lead	[name]	Accreditation, lost-child point, reporting concerns
Volunteers (12–15)	Parents & senior players	Pitch marshals, results runners, check-in, family zone

9 Timeline

WHEN	MILESTONE
12 weeks before	Date and venue provisionally booked. Sanction application to the LFA/region. Sponsor approaches start.
10 weeks before	Entry pack and invitation sent to clubs. Event categorisation started with the municipality and SAPS.
6 weeks before	Go/no-go decision. Referees, first aid, marquee and toilets confirmed.
3 weeks before	Entries close. Fixtures drawn and published. Volunteer roster done. Medals ordered.
1 week before	Safety briefing. Team lists and medical forms received. Programme printed.
Event day	07:00 setup · 07:45 check-in · 08:30 opening · group stage · 13:00 knockouts & placement matches · 15:30 finals · 16:15 awards · 17:00 pack-down.
2–4 weeks after	Results, photos (consented) and thank-you to all clubs. Sponsor report with reach, attendance and finances.

10 How we will measure success

≥ 18

teams entered (24 target)

≥ 4

matches for every team

0

serious safety or
safeguarding incidents

≥ 80%

of clubs say they'd return
(post-event survey)

Our goal is to make the Growfit Youth Cup a **twice-yearly fixture** (June/July and December holidays) that grassroots clubs in Durban look forward to, and that grows with its sponsors.

Get involved. Clubs can enter with the form on the next page. Sponsors and supporters can contact **[name, phone, email]** .

Growfit Youth Cup: team entry form

One form per team. Send to **[email]** by **[closing date]** with proof of payment.

Club name

Age group

☐ U12 ☐ U15 ☐ U17

Affiliation (LFA / league)

Head coach name

Head coach phone / email

Second team official

Emergency contact on the day

Number of players (max 14)

Declarations by the club

- ☐ All players are registered with SAFA / our LFA and are within the age group.
- ☐ We hold parent/guardian consent for each player to take part, and medical/emergency details for each player will be brought on the day.
- ☐ We hold photo/media consent for players who may be filmed or photographed, and we will tell organisers about any player who must not be filmed.
- ☐ Our officials hold valid police/CPR Part B clearance and will follow the tournament code of conduct.

Payment

Entry fee: **R4,000 per team** (early-bird R3,500 for the first 12 paid entries before **[date]** , payable in two instalments), by EFT to **[bank, account name, account number, branch code]** . Reference: **[club name + age group]** . Refunded in full if the event does not go ahead.

Signed for the club

Name: _____

Role: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Received by Growfit

Name: _____

Payment confirmed: ☐

Date: ____ / ____ / ____